TRAIN-THE-TRAINER · CREDENTIAL KIT

Community Trainer Readiness Kit

Preparing community trainers to teach first-time AI users well

A competency framework, learning path, observable teaching-readiness rubric, teach-back observation form and credential assessment for community trainers who lead beginner ChatGPT workshops for small businesses, nonprofits, educators and workforce programs.

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Portfolio sample by Chester M. Independent work prepared for a job application. Not official OpenAI material, not an OpenAI credential, and not endorsed by OpenAI. Product features and settings change often: trainers confirm current availability before every session.

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SECTION 1

How to use this kit

A community trainer is ready when they can do three things reliably: use the product fluently, teach beginners in a way that builds real skill, and protect learners by modeling verification, privacy and good judgment about what belongs in a beginner session.

Program leads

Use the framework and learning path to recruit, onboard and schedule trainers. Use the rubric and pass standard to make consistent, defensible credential decisions.

Observers and mentors

Run the teach-back with the protocol in Section 5. Rate only what you see and hear, write evidence for every rating, and give one clear development goal.

Trainer candidates

Use the framework as a self-check, follow the learning path, and practice with the rubric before your teach-back. Nothing in the assessment is a surprise.

Design principles

- **Evidence over attendance.** The credential rests on observed teaching and a practical task, not on hours completed.
- **Observable standards.** Every rubric level describes behavior an observer can see or hear, so two observers reach the same decision.
- **Responsible use is non-negotiable.** Verification and privacy are critical criteria: strong presentation skills cannot compensate for a gap here.
- **Stay current.** Products change. Trainers are credentialed on habits (test in the learner's environment, check current documentation) rather than on a memorized feature list.
- **Know the edge of the room.** Recognizing when a question needs a technical specialist is a competency, not a failure.

The credential at a glance

Who	Community trainers and advisors who lead beginner workshops (no engineering background required)
Time to credential	About 10–12 hours over 3–5 weeks
Evidence required	Practice log · scenario assessment · practical task · observed 20-minute teach-back
Maintenance	Quarterly product-update briefing · one observed session and a refresh each year

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SECTION 2

Competency framework

Five domains describe what a credentialed community trainer can do. Each competency maps to the evidence that shows it.

Domain	A ready trainer can…	Evidence
A · Product proficiency	1. Use ChatGPT fluently for core everyday tasks (write, rewrite, summarize, brainstorm, plan) and refine results over several turns. 2. Explain in plain language what ChatGPT is, why responses vary, and why it can be confidently wrong. 3. Find and explain the account's data and privacy settings; find current plan and feature information in official sources rather than relying on memory. 4. Test every demo and activity in the account types and devices learners will use, and adapt when features differ.	Practice log · Practical task B2 · Teach-back demo · Environment-check record
B · Facilitation	1. Open with clear outcomes and keep learners hands-on for at least half the session. 2. Demonstrate live while narrating their thinking, and recover calmly from unexpected outputs. 3. Coach with questions during practice instead of taking over the keyboard. 4. Run a timed challenge (Jam): set-up, time calls, coaching, scoring and debrief.	Teach-back · Co-facilitation feedback
C · Responsible use and verification CRITICAL	1. Teach and model the four checks (facts, promises, fit and tone, fairness) on a live output. 2. Teach privacy habits (no private customer data, use placeholders) and respond calmly when a learner makes a privacy mistake. 3. Answer questions about data use, pricing and features accurately, or say "I'm not sure" and point to the official source. 4. Flag higher-stakes topics (legal, tax, health, finance, employment) that need official sources or qualified professionals.	Assessment A (critical items) · Practical task B1 · Teach-back
D · Adapting to the audience	1. Translate examples into the audience's real work (small business, nonprofit, classroom, job seeker). 2. Read the room and adjust pace, grouping and challenge for beginners and experienced learners in the same session. 3. Apply accessibility and inclusion practices: readable screens, read-aloud, captions, plain language, never color alone, psychological safety.	Teach-back · Practical task B2 adaptation notes
E · Knowing limits and escalating	1. Distinguish beginner workshop content from builder or technical content (APIs, integrations, agents, coding, compliance). 2. Make a warm referral to a technical specialist, follow-up session or official support without losing the learner. 3. Record learner questions, friction and feedback after each session and share patterns with the program team.	Assessment A (critical item) · Teach-back planted question · Post-session notes

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SECTION 3

Learning path

Five stages, about 10–12 hours over 3–5 weeks. Each stage ends with evidence, so candidates and program leads can see progress.

1 Foundations
Self-paced · ~3 hrs

2 Observe
Live · ~2 hrs

3 Practice
Train-the-trainer · ~3 hrs

4 Demonstrate
Assessment · ~2–3 hrs

5 Maintain
Ongoing

Stage	What the candidate does	Evidence produced
1 · Foundations	Uses ChatGPT on five real tasks over one week, verifying each with the four checks. Completes a responsible-use module (privacy, verification, higher-stakes topics). Reads the workshop facilitator guide and deck notes.	Practice log: 5 tasks, each with the request, one follow-up, what was checked and what was changed
2 · Observe	Attends a live beginner workshop, first as a participant, then reviews a recording or second session using the observation form to note facilitator moves.	Completed observation form with three techniques to adopt
3 · Practice	Joins a 90-minute train-the-trainer session: demo drills, tricky-question role-play, room-reading scenarios and Jam coaching practice. Co-facilitates one segment of a live workshop with a lead trainer.	Peer feedback notes · lead trainer's co-facilitation feedback
4 · Demonstrate	Completes the scenario assessment (Part A) and the practical task (Part B). Delivers a 20-minute observed teach-back (Section 5).	Scores against the pass standard · completed observation form · readiness decision
5 · Maintain	Attends quarterly product-update briefings and re-tests demos after changes. Once a year: one observed live session and a short refresh assessment.	Updated environment-check record · annual observation form

Train-the-trainer session (90 minutes)

1. Open: what makes a beginner session work (10)
2. Demo drills in pairs, with planted surprises (25)
3. Tricky-question role-play using cards (20)
4. Room-reading scenarios: "what would you do?" (15)
5. Jam coaching practice with the rubric (15)
6. Commit: teach-back segment and date (5)

Support along the way

- A named mentor (a credentialed lead trainer) for each candidate
- Office hours before teach-back week
- The full rubric and assessment format are shared on day one: no surprises
- Candidates who are not yet ready get a specific development plan and a re-observation date

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SECTION 4

Teaching-readiness rubric

Rate each criterion from what you observe in the teach-back. Each level includes the one below it. **Ready** is the credential standard; **Mentor** marks trainers who can coach others.

Criterion	1 · Emerging	2 · Developing	3 · Ready	4 · Mentor
1. Product fluency in demos	Demo stalls or relies on pre-made screenshots; cannot explain why an output varies.	Completes the demo but hesitates; explains outputs in jargon; avoids follow-ups.	Types live and narrates thinking; uses at least one follow-up; explains in plain language why outputs vary.	Turns an unexpected output into a teaching moment on the spot; shows two ways to reach the goal.
2. Clarity and structure	No stated outcomes; segment runs over by 5+ minutes or ends abruptly.	Outcomes stated but not revisited; instructions sometimes need repeating.	States outcomes, gives one-step-at-a-time instructions, checks understanding, finishes within ±2 minutes.	Links every activity to the outcome; adjusts timing visibly and still lands the close.
3. Hands-on practice and coaching	Mostly lecture; learners watch rather than do.	Learners practice, but the trainer takes over keyboards or gives answers.	Learners hands-on within 5 minutes of the segment start; trainer coaches with questions ("What does it not know yet?").	Pairs learners deliberately; experienced learners coach peers; every learner leaves with a usable result.
4. Reading the room, adapting and access	Misses visible confusion; one pace for everyone; screen hard to read.	Notices confusion but responds late or only by repeating.	Responds to cues within a minute (re-demo, starter prompt, stretch task); zooms screen, reads outputs aloud, uses plain language.	Differentiates for beginners and advanced learners at once; anticipates access needs before they're raised.
5. Responsible use and verification CRITICAL	Presents outputs as reliable; no privacy guidance; or states something inaccurate about data, pricing or features.	Mentions checking and privacy but does not model them on a real output.	Models at least one verification check on a live output; teaches the placeholder habit; answers data and feature questions accurately or points to the official source.	Learners find the error themselves; trainer handles a learner's privacy slip calmly and turns it into a group habit.
6. Questions and escalation	Guesses at answers, or dismisses the question.	Answers accurately but goes deep on a technical tangent, losing the room.	Answers beginner questions briefly; recognizes builder or technical questions and makes a warm referral; logs the question.	Uses the question to reinforce a core habit, and offers a safe next step the learner can try today.

Readiness decision

- **Ready:** Level 3 or higher on all six criteria.
- **Ready with conditions:** Level 2 on one criterion other than 5, all others at 3+. Co-facilitate once more; re-observe that criterion only.
- **Not yet ready:** any Level 1, Level 2 on two or more criteria, or below Level 3 on criterion 5.

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SECTION 5

Teach-back protocol

A 20-minute observed segment that simulates a real beginner workshop, including two planted moments every trainer will meet in the field.

Time	What happens
Before	The candidate is assigned one segment of the workshop (for example, "Try it: ask and improve" or "Stay safe") and an audience (small business, nonprofit, educators or a workforce program). They prepare in the account type learners would use and bring their environment-check record.
0–12 min	Candidate teaches the segment live to 3–6 peers playing beginners. Peers type along on their own devices.
During	The observer cues two planted moments: **(1) a tricky question** drawn from the card set below, and **(2) a room cue**, such as a peer who visibly gives up, or a peer who pastes a (fictional) customer phone number.
12–15 min	Candidate self-assesses against the rubric: one strength, one thing to change.
15–20 min	Observer gives feedback: evidence-based ratings, one strength, one development goal, and the readiness decision (or when it will be shared).

Observer rules

Rate behavior you saw or heard, not intent or potential. Write one piece of evidence for every rating. When torn between two levels, choose the lower and name what would raise it. Calibrate: a second observer co-rates every fifth teach-back.

Tricky-question cards

Data: "Does everything I type get used to train it?"
Look for: "Depends on account type and settings" → show settings → point to official policy. No guessing.

Pricing: "Which plan should I buy for my shop?"
Look for: no recommendation from memory; point to the current official plan page; suggest trying core tasks first.

Technical: "Can you show us how to connect it to our booking system so it replies automatically?"
Look for: warm referral to a specialist or follow-up session; logs it; offers a safe task to try today.

Accuracy: "It told me my city's permit rules. Can I rely on that?"
Look for: treat as a starting point; confirm with the official agency or a professional.

Skeptic: "Isn't this all just made-up text?"
Look for: validates the concern; connects it to the verification habit; invites the skeptic to be the "editor."

Different screen: "My screen has buttons yours doesn't."
Look for: explains features vary by plan, device and updates; keeps the activity on core text chat.

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SECTION 6

Teach-back observation form

Candidate _____ Observer _____

Date _____ Segment taught _____

Audience simulated _____ Format: ☐ In person ☐ Virtual

Part 1 · Observable behaviors

Behavior	Yes	Partly	No	Evidence (what you saw or heard)
States the segment's outcomes	☐	☐	☐	
Learners hands-on within 5 minutes	☐	☐	☐	
Live demo, narrated, with a follow-up	☐	☐	☐	
Example from the audience's real work	☐	☐	☐	
Coaches with questions; doesn't take over	☐	☐	☐	
Models a verification check CRITICAL	☐	☐	☐	
Teaches the privacy habit CRITICAL	☐	☐	☐	
Responds to the room cue within ~1 minute	☐	☐	☐	
Handles the tricky question accurately	☐	☐	☐	
Accessible: readable screen, read-aloud	☐	☐	☐	
Finishes within ±2 min, clear close	☐	☐	☐	

Part 2 · Rubric ratings (circle one level per criterion)

1. Product fluency in demos	(1) (2) (3) (4)	Evidence:
2. Clarity and structure	(1) (2) (3) (4)	Evidence:
3. Hands-on practice and coaching	(1) (2) (3) (4)	Evidence:
4. Reading the room, adapting and access	(1) (2) (3) (4)	Evidence:
5. Responsible use and verification CRITICAL	(1) (2) (3) (4)	Evidence:
6. Questions and escalation	(1) (2) (3) (4)	Evidence:

Part 3 · Feedback and decision

Strongest moment

One development goal (specific and observable)

Decision: ☐ Ready ☐ Ready with conditions (criterion: _____) ☐ Not yet ready (re-observe by: _____)

Observer initials: _____

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SECTION 7

Credential assessment

Two parts. Part A checks judgment in realistic situations (25 minutes, open notes). Part B checks the skills in practice (about 60 minutes, submitted before the teach-back).

Part A · Scenarios Choose the best response. Items marked CRITICAL must be answered correctly to pass.

1. Mid-workshop, a learner says their screen shows a tool that isn't on your demo screen, and their neighbor doesn't see it either. What is the best response?

A. Tell them their account may have a problem and to contact support after the session.
B. Explain that features vary by plan, device and updates; keep the activity on core text chat; note it for your post-session report.
C. Recommend that everyone upgrade so the room has the same features.
D. Pause the session to troubleshoot until both screens match.

2. CRITICAL A nonprofit volunteer coordinator pastes a list of volunteers' names and phone numbers to draft reminder texts. What do you do?

A. Let them continue; it's for a good cause and the task is low risk.
B. Point out the mistake to the whole room so everyone learns from it.
C. Quietly suggest removing the personal details and using placeholders, show how to delete that chat, then reinforce the habit with the whole group without naming anyone.
D. Reassure them that pasted information is never stored.

3. CRITICAL A learner asks, "Is what I type used to train the model?" What is the best answer?

A. "No, never."
B. "Yes, always, so don't use it for work."
C. "It depends on your account type and settings. Let's look at the data controls together, and the official privacy policy and help center have the current answer."
D. "I wouldn't worry about it for small-business tasks."

4. During your live demo, ChatGPT writes a holiday-hours post with hours you never gave it. What is the best move?

A. Regenerate quietly until the output looks right.
B. Ask the room what's wrong, let them find the invented hours, then show the fix: give it the real facts or delete the guess.
C. Explain that this only happens on free accounts.
D. Skip ahead to the next slide to keep time.

5. CRITICAL An owner asks you to show how to connect ChatGPT to their point-of-sale system so it replies to orders automatically. What do you do?

A. Improvise a demo of integrations so the learner isn't disappointed.
B. Say it can't be done.
C. Acknowledge the goal, explain it's beyond a beginner session, take their details for a specialist or follow-up session, log it, and offer a safe task they can try today.
D. Suggest they search online for a tutorial.

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6. Three minutes into practice, about half the room hasn't typed anything. What is the best response?

A. Wait; silence means people are thinking.
B. Pause everyone and co-write one request on screen with a volunteer's business, step by step, then restart practice.
C. Move on to the next segment to protect the agenda.
D. Tell learners to copy your demo request exactly.

7. You'll teach at a workforce center where learners use free accounts on shared library computers. Which preparation matters most?

A. Rehearse the demo in your own paid account.
B. Test every demo and activity in a free account on similar computers and network within the last week, and plan sign-out guidance for shared devices.
C. Skip testing because the deck has already been approved.
D. Ask learners to bring their own laptops instead.

8. A learner with low vision joins your virtual session. Which approach best supports them?

A. Send the slides afterward.
B. Use color-coding to highlight important parts of the output.
C. Zoom the screen to 150% or more, read every request and response aloud, keep captions on and share an accessible digital worksheet.
D. Pair them with someone who can tell them what's on screen.

9. A learner used ChatGPT to look up their city's permit requirements for a food truck. What do you tell them?

A. The answer is reliable if it sounds specific.
B. Use it as a starting point to understand the terms and prepare questions, then confirm with the city's official source or a qualified professional.
C. Ask ChatGPT whether it is sure.
D. Never use AI for anything related to rules.

10. A Jam pair produces a polished customer reply that includes a 15% discount the owner never approved. How should "Checked & safe" be scored on the Jam rubric?

A. 3: the writing is excellent.
B. 2: facts were mostly right.
C. 1: an unapproved promise means the output wasn't checked; coach them to remove it, then re-score.
D. Don't score it; the discount is minor.

Part B · Practical task

B1 · Verify and revise (20 minutes)

A food bank coordinator asked ChatGPT to draft a volunteer recruitment post. Compare the draft to the coordinator's notes. List every problem you find, say how you would confirm or fix each one, then write a corrected post.

Coordinator's notes (the source of truth)

> Volunteer day: Saturday, March 6, 9 a.m. to 12 p.m. · Community hall, 210 Elm Street · Sorting and packing food boxes · Ages 14+ (under 18 needs a signed guardian form) · No experience needed; closed-toe shoes required · Sign up on our website · Last year volunteers packed about 1,800 boxes.

AI draft to review

> Join us Sunday, March 6, from 9 a.m. to 1 p.m. at 210 Elm Street! Last year our amazing volunteers packed 18,000 boxes and served 12,000 families in need. No experience needed, but volunteers must be able-bodied and able to lift 50 lbs. Every volunteer gets a free lunch and a certificate of service hours! Questions? Call our coordinator Dana on her personal cell, 555-0142. "Volunteering here changed my life." – Maria G., who received food boxes after losing her job.

B2 · Build a 10–minute beginner activity (40 minutes)

Choose one audience: a small business, a nonprofit, classroom educators or job seekers in a workforce program. Use ChatGPT to design and test a 10-minute hands-on activity for first-time users. Submit:

1. **The activity:** learning objective, learner instructions, and one starter request.
2. **Your test:** the requests you used, the outputs, and the follow-ups you tried, tested in the account type learners will use.
3. **Verification log:** what you checked in the outputs, how, and what you changed.
4. **Adaptation notes:** one change for beginners, one stretch for experienced learners, and one accessibility consideration.
5. **Boundary note:** one question this activity might raise that you would refer to a specialist, and how you would refer it.

Practical task scoring (0–3 per criterion, 15 points)

Criterion	0–1	2	3
B1 · Problems found CRITICAL	Fewer than 5 of 9 issues found; misses privacy issues	5–6 issues, including both privacy issues	7–9 issues, including both privacy issues
B1 · Corrected post	Errors remain or new claims added	Accurate, but missing a required detail	Accurate, complete, warm and inclusive
B2 · Activity design	Unclear objective; not beginner-friendly	Clear and usable; generic example	Clear, hands-on, grounded in the audience's real work
B2 · Testing and verification CRITICAL	Not tested, or no verification log	Tested; log is general	Tested in the learner's account type; specific checks and changes recorded
B2 · Adaptation and boundaries	Missing two or more notes	All notes present; one is vague	Specific, realistic notes and a warm referral

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SECTION 8

Answer key and pass standard

Part A answers

#	Key	Why
1	**B**	Features vary and change; core activities should never depend on them. Logging it keeps materials current.
2	**C**	**Critical item.** Protects the people in the data, preserves the learner's dignity and builds the habit for everyone. D makes a claim the trainer can't make.
3	**C**	**Critical item.** Accurate without guessing; data handling depends on account and settings and changes over time. A, B and D are unsupported claims.
4	**B**	Learners discover the error themselves, which is the most memorable way to learn verification. C is a false claim.
5	**C**	**Critical item.** Recognizes the edge of a beginner session, keeps the learner engaged and routes demand to the right specialists.
6	**B**	A third or more stuck means the demo moved too fast; a shared, scaffolded example resets the room.
7	**B**	Test in the environment learners will use; shared devices need sign-out guidance to protect learners' accounts.
8	**C**	Combines visual, auditory and text access. B relies on color; D removes independence.
9	**B**	Higher-stakes, local and changeable rules need an official source or professional. D overcorrects.
10	**C**	The rubric rewards the checking habit; an unapproved promise is exactly what the "Promises" check catches.

B1 · The nine planted issues

1. **Wrong day:** Sunday (notes say Saturday)
2. **Wrong end time:** 1 p.m. (notes say 12 p.m.)
3. **Inflated number:** 18,000 boxes (notes say about 1,800)
4. **Invented statistic:** "12,000 families" is not in the notes
5. **Exclusionary requirement:** "able-bodied, lift 50 lbs" is not in the notes and may discourage people unnecessarily
6. **Unapproved promise:** free lunch and service-hours certificate
7. **Privacy:** a staff member's personal cell number
8. **Privacy and fabrication:** invented testimonial naming a food-box recipient
9. **Missing required details:** ages 14+ with guardian form; closed-toe shoes; sign up on the website

Credential pass standard

Part A · Scenarios	8 of 10 or higher, **and** all three critical items (2, 3, 5) correct
Part B · Practical	11 of 15 or higher, with a score of 2 or more on both critical criteria
Teach-back	"Ready" decision: Level 3+ on all six rubric criteria, including criterion 5
Not yet?	Candidates get written feedback and a development plan. They retake only the part they missed, after at least one practice session with a mentor.

Assessments should be reviewed with subject-matter experts and refreshed whenever product changes affect a scenario. Items are scenario-based on purpose: they test judgment that stays valid as features change.

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